

UCAT SCORE CALCULATION

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A Complete Guided to UCAT Success



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Q: How does the UCAT scoring system work?

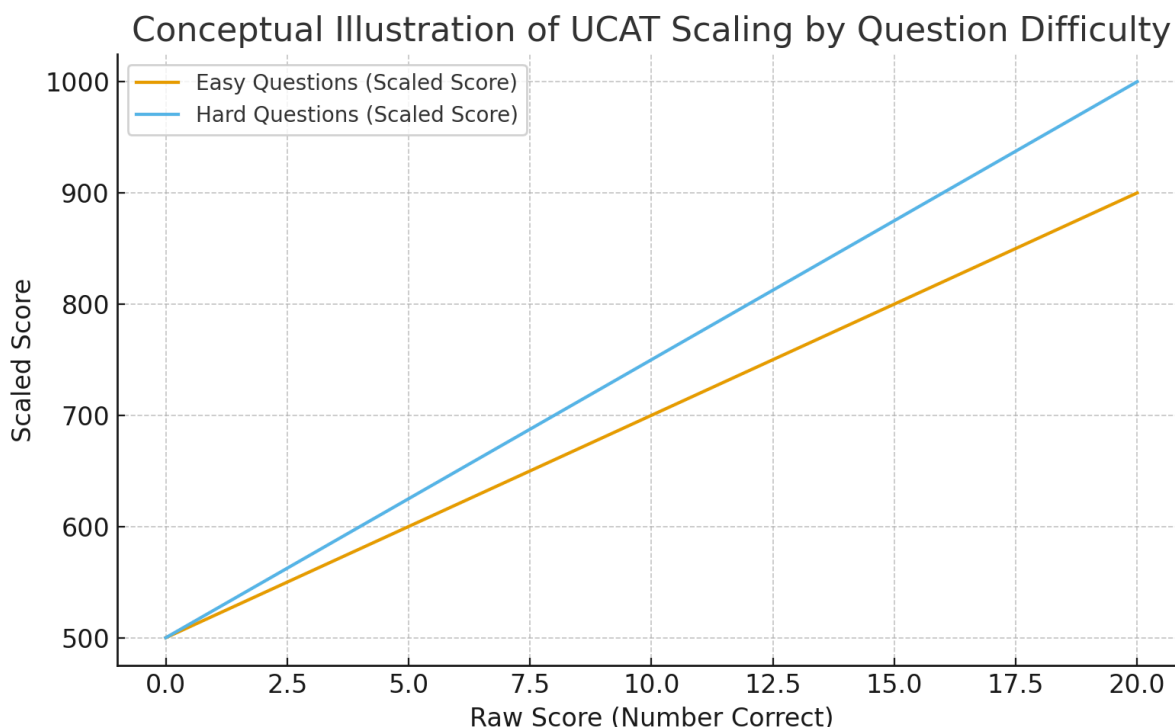
A: The UCAT uses a sophisticated scoring method called Item Response Theory (IRT), also known as Rasch modelling. Your final score isn't simply a count of correct answers. Instead, it considers multiple factors including:

- How many questions you answered correctly (your raw score)
- The difficulty level of each question
- Statistical measures like the Point Biserial Correlation Coefficient (PBCC)
- The likelihood of guessing answers correctly
- How different groups perform on specific questions (Differential Item Functioning)
- The overall performance of all test-takers in your cohort

This approach means your scaled score reflects your actual ability level rather than just a raw conversion of marks.

Q: Do all UCAT questions carry the same weight?

A: While every question awards the same number of raw marks, the final scoring accounts for question difficulty. For instance, if you correctly answer 20 challenging questions, you'll receive a higher scaled score than someone who answers 20 easier questions correctly. However, this doesn't mean you should skip easier questions—your total number of correct answers still matters significantly in the scoring calculation.



Q: Why do two students with the same raw score sometimes get different final scores?

A: Your scaled score depends not only on how many questions you answered correctly, but also *which* questions you got right. A student who correctly answers more difficult questions will achieve a higher scaled score than someone with the same number of correct answers on easier questions. This ensures that your score accurately represents your ability level.

Q: How many different test versions are used in the official UCAT exam?

A: Each year, Pearson VUE uses 5 different versions of the UCAT test. You're randomly assigned to one of these versions when you sit the exam. This system helps maintain test integrity, reduces opportunities for cheating, and prevents test content from being compromised or shared.

Q: How are scores calculated for each section?

A: For the cognitive subtests (Verbal Reasoning, Decision Making, Quantitative Reasoning, Abstract Reasoning, and Inductive Reasoning), your score is based purely on correct answers—there's no penalty for wrong

answers. Each subtest generates a scaled score ranging from 300 to 900, with adjustments made to account for variations in difficulty across different test versions.

Q: Is the Situational Judgement Test (SJT) scored differently?

A: Yes, the SJT uses a unique scoring approach. Your responses are compared against ideal answers determined by experts. You can receive partial credit when your response is close to, but not exactly, the ideal answer. Rather than receiving a numerical score, you're placed into one of four performance bands:

- **Band 1:** Highest performance—demonstrates excellent professional judgement
- **Band 2:** Good performance with strong alignment to ideal responses
- **Band 3:** Adequate performance with reasonable judgement
- **Band 4:** Lower performance with less alignment to professional standards